



CHARTED



RCM Cooperative Monthly Meetups



Meeting Practice

1. Code of Conduct
2. Presentation and discussion will be recorded (discussion not published) - recording will be shared.
3. All links will be shared in zoom (slides, doc, form)
4. Add “w-” or “s-” in front of your zoom name to indicate your interaction preference
5. We'd love to see you, so please turn on your camera if you can - take a break if needed.
6. All questions are welcome through chat and by raising virtual hand (Zoom 🙋)
7. You can take notes for future reference - we have shared notes. Please credit contributions!
8. Connect with each other others on RCM Cooperative slack



Cryptpad demo

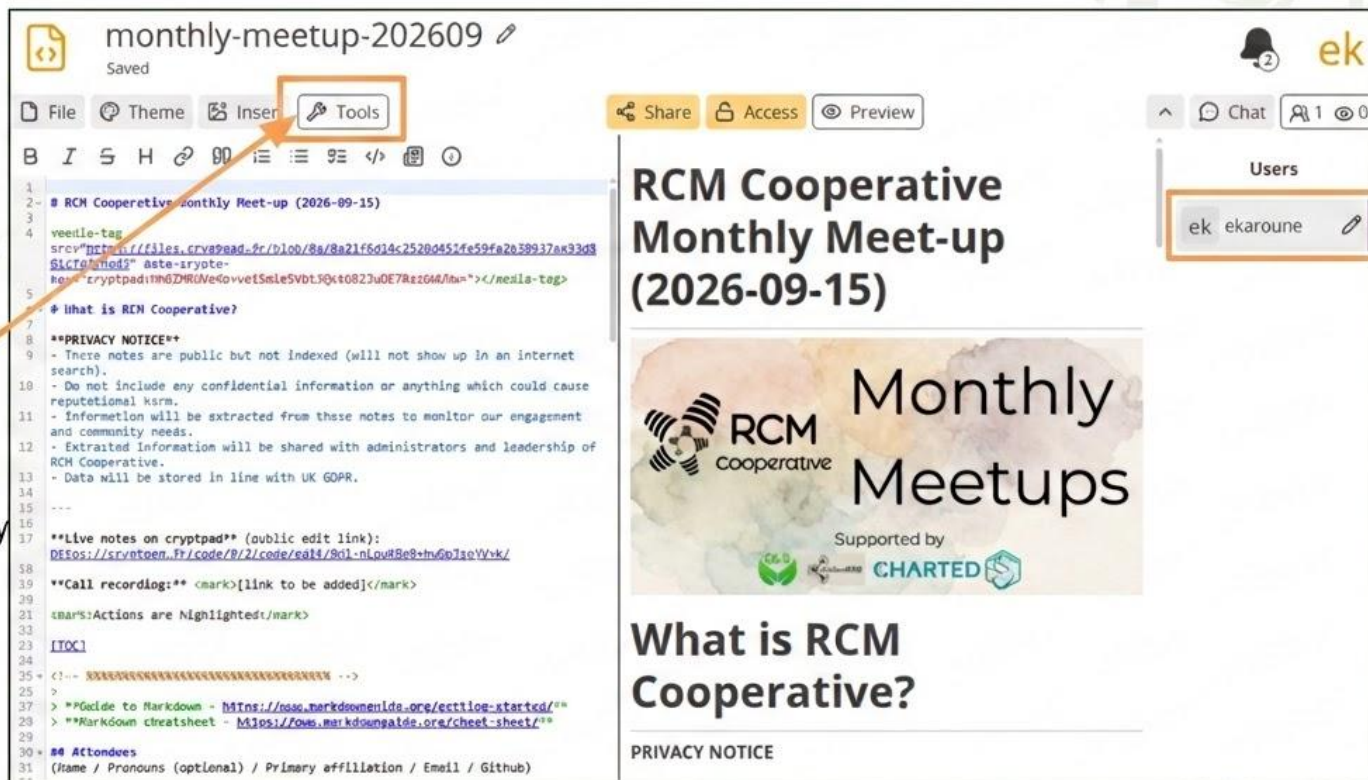
GETTING STARTED WITH CRYPTPAD

 Write this side:

Markdown editing interface and notes

B **#↓** Format with Markdown:
Use formatting buttons or type markdown directly

1 
2 
3 
Navigate with Line Numbers
Easy reference for collaborative editing

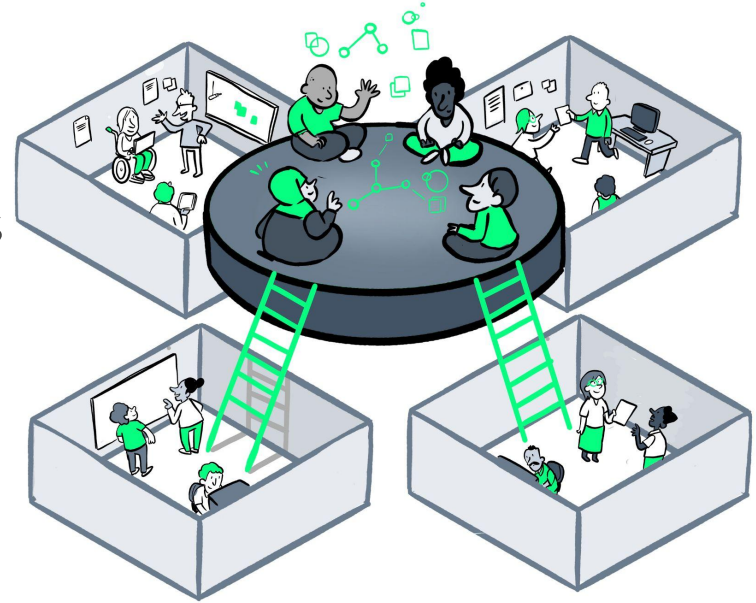


The screenshot displays the Cryptpad web interface. On the left, the editor shows a document titled "monthly-meetup-202609" with a "Tools" button highlighted by an orange box and an arrow pointing to it. The document content includes a heading "RCM Cooperative Monthly Meet-up (2026-09-15)", a "veetle-tag" section with a URL, a "lihat is RCM Cooperative?" section, a "PRIVACY NOTICE" section, and a "Live notes on cryptpad" section. On the right, the preview pane shows the rendered document with the same heading, a logo for "RCM cooperative", and a "Monthly Meetups" banner. Below the banner is a section titled "What is RCM Cooperative?" and a "PRIVACY NOTICE" section. The interface also includes a "Share" button, an "Access" button, a "Preview" button, a "Chat" button, and a "Users" list showing "ek" and "ekaroune".

Problem

Lots of folks in research do community work or work in community roles, but...

- Are not recognised for their contributions
- Are not rewarded for their contributions
- Have very little/no training or support for their work
- Have no clear career pathway



Scriberia 



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building sustainable research communities

Monthly Meetup September 2026 | [10.5281/zenodo.22747725](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22747725) | CC-BY-4.0



RCM Cooperative

BUILDING SUSTAINABLE RESEARCH COMMUNITIES

TELL ME MORE

We work **with and for communities** to **develop and refine** their capacity
for **equitable, resilient and collaborative** research.

www.rcmcooperative.com



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building sustainable research communities

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About us



Cassandra Gould van Praag

Co-Executive Director & Co-Founder
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Training and Community Lead,
Open Life Sciences



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Communities we have managed and supported



AI for Multiple Long-term Conditions
Research Support Facility



Innovate
UK

BridgeAI

The
Alan Turing
Institute



Data Science
Without Borders



Montreal Neurological
Institute-Hospital



Clinical AI

How can AI be usefully deployed to provide clinical benefits?

Modelling and high-precision forecasting of complex environmental systems to make leaps in weather prediction and sustainable energy

Environment and
sustainability



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Current activities

	2025	2026	2027
Community mapping and strategy	ADRUk TOSI	UKTRE BioFAIR	Manchester ERN RS Maintenance fund - LORIS-BIDS
RCM research and community building		DisCouRSE 1 CHARTED	DisCouRSE 2
RCM training	SSI	SSI BioFAIR	SSI



What are Monthly Meetups?

Place for those in formal and informal research community management roles, or just interested in research community work, to gather together to:

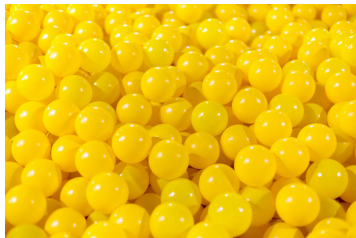
- **Build capacity** by sharing skills, tools, or practices applied in community work;
- **Build a network** of peers who can offer informal support, guidance, opportunities or resources relevant to community work;
- **Support professionalisation** by strengthening our ability to describe or advocate for RCMs.

We will hear from our community of RCMs sharing their knowledge and real-world experience.

What would you like to see at a meetup? 🤔

Learn about who's here

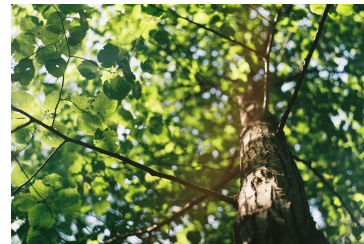
1. **Desk treasure hunt (2 mins)**
2. **Break out room (10 mins)**
 - Introduce yourself: Who you are and what you do
 - Show and discuss your treasures!



Something yellow



A book



Something natural



What is a “Cooperative”?

The logo for CO-OPERATIVES UK, featuring the text in white on a red rectangular background.

A business or organisation that is democratically owned and controlled by its members, to meet their shared needs. The members can be its customers, employees, residents or suppliers, who have a say in how the co-op is run.



Consumer owned and hierarchically managed; ethical positioning aligned with cooperative principles and reinforced by member governance.

The Suma logo, featuring the word 'Suma' in a large, teal, sans-serif font, with 'CO-OPERATIVE SINCE 1977' in a smaller, teal, sans-serif font below it.

A large worker co-op (no managers, equal pay), frequently used as a business-school case study on flat/democratic organisation.

The Mondragon logo, featuring a stylized blue 'm' icon above the text 'Mondragon' and 'Unibertsitatea' in a bold, dark blue, sans-serif font.

Worker co-op with equal pay ratios and one-member-one-vote governance, keeping power distributed rather than concentrated in professional management; workers are directly responsible for the long-term strategic direction.



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Defining features of cooperatives

6 Core values

4 Ethical values

7 Principles

All cooperatives follow these:

- **Values:** the ethical/philosophical foundation
- **Principles:** the operational expression of those values



Core and ethical values

- Self-help
- Self-responsibility
- Democracy
- Equality
- Equity
- Solidarity

- Honesty
- Openness
- Social responsibility
- Caring for others



Cooperative principles define operations

1. **Voluntary and Open Membership** – open to all able to use its services and willing to accept the responsibilities of membership, without discrimination.
2. **Democratic Member Control** – members actively participate in setting policies and making decisions;
3. **Member Economic Participation** – members contribute to the co-op's capital.
4. **Autonomy and Independence** – co-ops are self-help organisations controlled by their members.
5. **Education, Training and Information** – provided so members can contribute effectively and inform the public about the nature and benefits of co-operation.
6. **Cooperation Among Cooperatives** – strengthen the movement by working together through local, national, regional and international structures.
7. **Concern for Community** – working for the sustainable development of communities through policies approved by members.



RCM Cooperative - How we apply the principles

1. **Voluntary and Open Membership** – Anyone can be a member once you reach the criteria.
2. **Democratic Member Control** – Members vote on Board of Directors, motions and bylaws, profit distribution, high strategy decisions.
3. **Member Economic Participation** – Members contribute through participation in /delivery of activities
4. **Autonomy and Independence** – Fiscal hosting through OLS. Contract term redline around open licensing of developed materials.
5. **Education, Training and Information** – These MMs grant funded and free for the community to attend.
6. **Cooperation Among Cooperatives** – Building relationships with other academic Co-ops!
7. **Concern for Community** – Advocating for professionalisation of RCM careers; leading research culture conversations.



Who is RCM Cooperative for?

- **Professional and informal roles:** People with RCM responsibility or endorsers of research communities.
- **Shared values:** Inferred through participation
- **Anyone “in good standing”** and not “disgraced” (Code of Conduct)

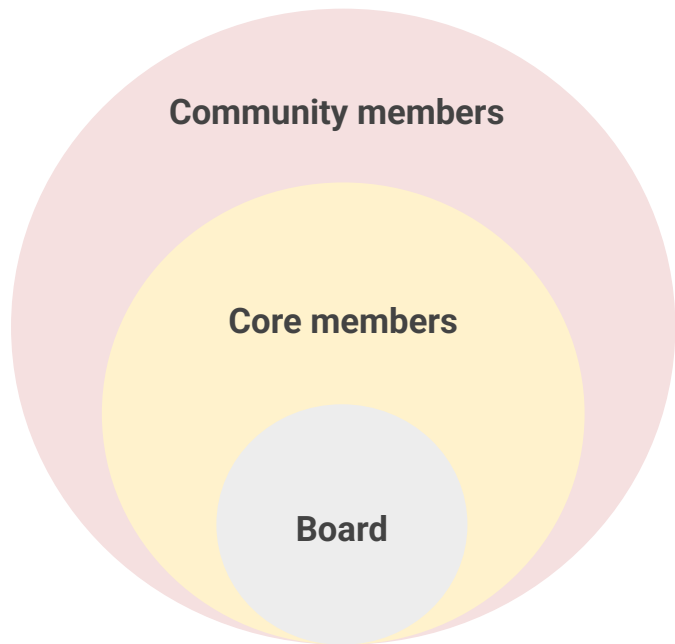
Membership type offered depending on your contribution:

1. **Community members:** Lower contribution, lower decision making power (25%)
2. **Core members:** Higher contribution, more decision making power (75%)

Quorum proposed: 20% Core members and 50% Community members, to stop decisions being made on unrepresentative participation.



RCM Cooperative structure



1. **Community members**

- a. Attended at least two events in a year, and/or;
- b. Show sustained engagement and contribution to our community workspaces for a minimum of three months.

2. **Core members**

- a. Contributed for a minimum of six months toward a Co-Op deliverable; and/or
- b. Shown sustained active engagement and contribution to our community workspaces for a minimum of six months.



Voting example

Proposal: split surplus 50% reinvestment : 50% member distribution.

Tier (vote %)	N.	Yes count	No count	Yes weighted	No weighted
Core (75%)	20	11	9	$(75\% \div 20) \times 11$ = 41.25%	$(75\% \div 20) \times 9$ = 33.75%
Community (25%)	200	20	180	$(25\% \div 200) \times 20$ = 2.5%	$(25\% \div 200) \times 180$ = 22.5%
Total				43.25%	56.25%

Result: Community overrules a divided core. Community acts as a check where Core doesn't have internal consensus.



Discussions on proposed RCM Cooperative membership model

1. Do you see yourself fitting into the membership structure? Why/Why not?
2. What benefits or incentives would be most valuable to you as a community or core member?

10 mins
breakout groups

Short share out
then session
feedback!



Thank you!



Your contributions ensure RCM Cooperative works for you!

Feedback form!

Membership structures and benefits will be written by the Board, incorporating your feedback.

Once in place, voting procedures will be rolled out!



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Next Monthly Meetup!

Speaker



Michael Donnay

Community Manager,
Institute of Research Software

Wednesday 21st October
1pm - 2pm UK time

Meetup theme

Community and
RCM narratives

Register here

https://us06web.zoom.us/join/6z9aCLqbqSVyLntm7_2a



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Get in touch

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